

Public sexual harassment mayhem on public transport in megacities - Karachi and London: A comparative review

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ABSTRACT

Background: Karachi and London as megacities face huge challenges of providing safe environment for women in public spaces. Fear of sexual harassment on buses may cause domestic and transit captivity in women as public space is regarded as male domain. Such situation of hue and cry should be addressed through a social reform to empower the women with their mobility rights.

Purpose: The purpose of this study is to expose the perils of public sexual harassment; women encounter on public transport in the megacities – Karachi & London. The paper reports on the findings from a comparative review of the existing literature, surveys and reports focusing on the predicaments of sexual offences and assaults women confront in public spaces or transport.

Methodology: Rapid evidence assessment (REA) methodology was employed to: search the all- inclusive literature within given time constraints; collate descriptive outlines of the available evidences; critically analyse and evaluate it; sieve out studies of poor quality; and provide an overview of the evidence.

Findings: Comparative review evinced the gravity of sexual harassment in the megacities – Karachi and London and formulated baseline evidences for the law enforcement agencies to take strict action against the perpetrators to attenuate the jeopardy of sexual harassment on public transport. Literature on sociological studies and psychiatric assessments reveals that the crime leaves the victims in havoc of psychological, physical and emotional distresses which in turn damages their mental, social and personal wellbeing.

Comparatively, the prevalence of the crime is much higher in Karachi than London as Karachi fared 2nd most perilous megacity for women while London named the best having the lowest rates in Thomson Reuters foundation Survey 2017. London has lower incidences of sexual harassment and assault, which may relate to the law protection provided to the women. Pakistan's Women Protection Act doesn't safeguard women on roads and buses as it applies to workplaces only. An immediate legislation is required for women to end sexual harassment on public transport vehicles as well.

Practical implications: More research needs to be done on the prevalence rates of sexual offence, harassment, and assault in Karachi and London with a view to provide safe and secured transit to women. The rising rates indicates an urgent need for social development interventions such as gender sensitization to curtail offending behaviours towards women on public transport.

1. Introduction/background

Degradation, abasement, harassment, disparagement, and ex-

ploitation of women is as old as the time itself. Unlike today's womankind in megacities,¹ women of the ancient times were not only deprived of their social identity and mobility rights² but also viewed

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¹ Megacity: An urban area with over 10 million inhabitants

[Source: United Nations, Department of Economic and Social Affairs, Population Division (2006). *World Urbanization Prospects: The 2005 Revision. Working Paper No. ESA/P/WP/200.*]

² Mobility right: Free movement in public.

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subservient to men and restricted to their homes. The upsurge of misogyny³ and sexist stereotypes instituted the exploitative foundation for sex slavery and trafficking of women. Women of the time could be sold and purchased in public as sex slaves at any time and by anyone (Sun Kim, 2002; Scott & Cavanaugh, 2004; Jones, 2005; Jones, 2012). Correspondingly, at present, women are being showcased as sex objects on media and are extensively treated as inferior to men in different spheres of life. Likewise, in various societies, the violent acts against women have not been viewed as violent by women themselves due to their tattered communal values and social attitudes. (Awan, 2004; Mangoli & Ganapati, 2009). Over the period, this social dichotomy between men and women has imbibed the misogynistic societal mindset that makes 'woman' a natural metonym for 'sexual attraction'. The dichotomous chasm led to the worst overtly sexual exploitation of women and added nativity to sexual violence and harassment in public places and transport (Gardner, 1995; Long, 2001; Scott & Cavanaugh, 2004). Lamentably, the quandary of public sexual harassment left ignored in literature until the mid of 20th century. Furthermore, the continued derogatory and abhorrent societal attitudes towards the victimized women intensified the 'agony of being a woman' in the megacities of this world. Due to the reason, the plight of sexual harassment victims remained unreported in the past. However, the issue of sexual offence against women has received worldwide attention in the recent years and considered as a serious crime. Recognizing the mounting concern of women mobility and safety; sexual crime against women has now been viewed as a public-order crime⁴ (Law Library, 2004; Oxford Bibliographies, 2015). Public sexual harassment has set to become a violation of social norms, customs and values across the world. Sexual offences on public transport cause immeasurable social harm, deem highly immoral and objectionable. Legally, such acts are outlawed and severely punished as many megacities (societies) have become victim of the crime across the globe (Francis, 2001; Larry, 2016).

2. Public sexual harassment in megacities: A mayhem

The magnitude of public sexual harassment in megacities is on the rise worldwide. Urban scientists, gender studies experts and lawmakers view the escalated risk of sexual harassment as a social consequence of the resurgence of gender equality in megacities (Awan, 2004; Hossain, 2006; Pradhan, 2011; Arthur-Worrey, 2011; Lecompte & Bocarejo, 2017). On the other hand, they argue that the economies of megacities cannot progress while its women regress. In megacities, majority of women face public or street harassment, sexual harassment and/or assaults on public transport. Sexual harassment and assault on roads and buses causes enormous communal harm and widely viewed as bizarre, unacceptable, harmful, and disruptive to the community's daily life. Harassment of women of sexual orientation in public places; such as parks, shopping-malls, streets, plazas, town squares, bus stops, and transport systems, is referred to as public sexual harassment which has become a serious problem in megacities (Bowman, 1993; Gardner, 1995; Phadke, 2013). Public sexual harassment is also known as eve-teasing, wolf-whistling at women or

street harassment. (Leonardo, 1981; Stop Violence Against Women: A project for the Advocates for Human Rights, 2014; End violence against women and girls: United Nations entity for gender equality and the empowerment of women, 2015; Vera-Gray, 2016) Theoretically, a wolf-whistle is categorized as an abusive and threatening behaviour and could be treated under 'public-order act offence' (Laville, 2016). It includes all kinds of unwelcomed sexual advances and physical contact; such as aggressive staring, cat-calling, touching, ogling, rubbing, groping, and lewd comments. Sexual assault in public is referred to an act of threatening and coercing women on streets or public transport or forcing women into non-consensual sexual activity (Lawlink, 1999; Gekoski, Gray, Adler, & Horvath, 2017). A report on Violence Against Women⁵ suggests that criminal codes should make such conduct a criminal offence punishable by law to provide safe environment for women in public spaces. (UN Special Rapporteur on Violence against Women (SRVAW), 2003).

Past research on public transport remained silent on the challenges of gender dimensions for four decades i.e., from 1950s to 1980s. The literature was completely gender blind on the addressal of women issues. Women remained neglected and haplessly ignored during the time (Rivera, 2007). The gender dimension of transport was noted in research from the early 1980s and the issue of sexual harassment has now received a fundamental attention in academic, legal and practitioner spheres, relatively less attention has been focused on the unique circumstances of reporting this criminal offence (Gekoski et al., 2017). In literature, public sexual harassment on streets and transport is divided into three categories; severe, moderately severe and least severe. Severe type of street or public sexual harassment includes rape, passing lewd or sexually explicit profane comments at a woman, physical acts such as following a woman, throwing things at her, groping, pinching or poking her. Instead, moderately severe type encompasses sexual innuendoes, references to a woman's gender or body that are not sexually explicit such as cat calling whereas least severe category covers staring or ogling, whistling and all other offensive comments men make at women that are unwelcomed by them (Kissling, 1991; Heben, 1994; Gardner, 1995).

This comparative study is aimed at exploring the causes of public sexual harassment mayhem in the megacities – London & Karachi. Explicitly, it seeks to determine the prevalence of such negative behaviours on public transport in the two cities, by reviewing existing literature, surveys and reports focusing on feminine gender's experiences. The study aim's to:

- Ascertain and infer the nature and kind of sexual offence (severe, moderately severe and least severe) on public transport in Karachi & London.
- Spot and discern the overall level of governmental concern to mitigate growing sexual harassment and assaults threats on public transport in the two megacities - London and Karachi.
- Acquire precise cognizance of the state law in the two megacities.
- Document the women's confidence and readiness in reporting the cases of sexual offences to stop it.

Literature narrative for the identification of the causes of public sexual harassment is formed through multi-disciplinary studies including sociology, psychology, psychiatry, criminology, and healthcare. Their significant perspectives are as follows and play a decisive role in determining the root causes of the escalating trend in awful attitudes and behaviours of men towards women in public spaces and on public transport (Tables 1 and 2).

³ The term misogyny is derived from a Greek word 'misogunia' which means a cultural attitude of hatred for the feminine gender. Renowned sociologist Allan G. Johnson defined it as a central part of the sexist prejudice and ideology that provides foundation for the oppression of females in male-dominated societies. "Misogyny can be manifested in numerous ways, including social exclusion, sex discrimination, hostility,....., belittling of women, violence against women, and sexual objectification".

⁴ In criminology, public-order crime is defined by Siegel (2004) as "crime which involves acts that interfere with the operations of society is the ability of people to function efficiently, i.e., it is behaviour that has been labelled criminal because it is contrary to shared norms, social values, and customs". Source: <http://law.jrank.org/pages/11962/Public-Order-Crimes.html>.

⁵ See: Report of the UN Special Rapporteur on Violence Against Women, para. 48, 2003.

2.1. Sociological perspective on public sexual harassment

Many sociologists adjudged sexual harassment in public transport or on roads as a common nuisance of daily routine for all those women who yearn for 'civilized' behaviour in public spaces (Tuerkheimer, 1997; Thomas, 1997; Laniya, 2005; Kearn, 2010). Others are of an opinion that the main reason of this obscene attitude is the breakdown of moral values among the present-day generation. The unprecedented deterioration of moral and ethical values in the megacity life is a result of an uncontrolled exposure of young generation to television, print, and social media. Openness and exposure to profanity and vulgarity through technology/media has contaminated the value system of the people living in megacities (Kissling, 1991; Pain, 1991; Plummer, 2002; Zippel, 2006; Renold & Ringrose, 2011). Awareness campaigns against sexual harassment are not very effective because internet media is also playing its negative role in popularizing 'pro-sexual behaviour' through pornographic websites and infusing uncivil attitude in the young generation (especially in male gender) that damages their value system (Bart, Freeman, & Kimball, 1985; Carse, 1995). The horrifying increase in the number of public sexual harassment incidents can be attributed to the deterioration of values, norms, attitudes and beliefs of the 'mis-directed' globalization forces. Bringing attitudinal change by revolutionizing the value system of the megacity life are the main keys to counter these anomic situations (Abeysundara, 2017).

2.2. Public sexual harassment is a paraphilic act: a psychiatric assessment

In psychology, sexual harassment on public transportation is perceived as a 'paraphilic' act⁶ in public and has now become an issue of public concern that affects women mobility across the world (Thomson Reuters Foundation, 2014; Kehoe, 2014; Battered Women's Support Services, 2015a; Inayathullah, 2017). Clinical Psychiatrist, Dr. N. Kumaranayake defined "paraphilia as the abnormal sexual behaviour or impulse characterized by intense sexual fantasies and urges that keep coming back" (Inayathullah, 2017). The research literature in psychology provides enormous evidences that paraphilias are the stimulus for public sexual harassment (Beech & Harkins, 2012; Patra, Bharadwaj, Shaha, & Das, 2013; Balon, 2016). Many psychologists and psychiatrists suggest that two commonly known paraphilic behaviours cause sexual harassment on the public transport. Those are Exhibitionism and Frotteurism or Touchism (Guterman, Martin, & Rudes, 2011; Balon, 2016; Clark, Jeglic, Calkins, & Tatar, 2016). Exhibitionism involves showcasing, flashing, exposing or displaying one's genitals publicly to strangers. Although, this condition is limited to public offence with no other harmful effects on any other individual, but this licentious exposure is prohibited and treated as a criminal act in many countries and observed as shameful offence (Bhugra, Popelyuk, & McMullen, 2010). Conversely, frotteurism includes a person's sexual desires such as touching or rubbing his or her genitals against the body of a non-consenting, unfamiliar person in a crowded public location. Men are much more likely to indulge in frotteurism than women (Inayathullah, 2017). Frotteurism is a criminal act in many jurisdictions, usually classified as a misdemeanor (Arboleda-Flórez, 2001). It is difficult to prosecute frotteurs as intent to touch is hard to prove in the court of law. In their defense statements, the accused often claims that the physical contact was accidental and submits apology in order not to incriminate himself. Incidents of exhibitionism and frotteurism most often happened in places related to public transportation (e.g., public buses, bus stops, subway trains or platforms) in the urban setting and adjudged as a

public order crime. (Haskins & Silva, 2006; Clark et al., 2016; Larry, 2016; Inayathullah, 2017).

2.3. Adverse effects of public sexual harassment on women health

Researches have determined that women are a victim class and becoming a target of this social crime. Women are victimized by men at high rates across the globe (Mangoli & Ganapati, 2009; Asian Development Bank, 2015; Gorbea, 2016). Especially in the megacities where millions of girls and women leave for work and education. Women are the biggest users of public transport in megacities and fighting back against rampant public sexual harassment which is a violent crime affecting their safety, security, and daily commute (Pradhan, 2011). In megacities, public sexual harassment has become a health hazard for women victims. The crime leaves the victim in havoc of psychological, physical and emotional distresses which in turn have both direct and indirect health effects. The spectrum of psychological symptoms includes long-term depression, acute stress, anxiety, sleeplessness and even post-traumatic stress disorder (PTSD) whereas physical symptoms are spanning over the manifestation of muscle aches, stress headaches, hyper tension & hypotension, diabetes and heart issues in chronic cases. Likewise, symptoms of emotional distress observed in the victims of sexual harassment. Emotional distress includes feelings of loss of self-esteem, isolation and helplessness, fear and anger, and nervousness. In-short, the felony of public sexual harassment damages victim's mental, social and personal wellbeing (Roosmalen & McDaniel, 1998; Spector, 2017).

3. Method

The research design is built on PICOC⁷ led Rapid evidence assessment (REA) methodology to understand what academic research, reports and grey-literature has discovered/reported about the prevalence of public sexual harassment in the megacities: Karachi and London. Following REA research questions are developed to respond to an urgent social and communal issue of sexual harassment mayhem in megacities.

PICOC Grid 1

REA Question no. 1	What is known in the existing scholarly and grey literature about the drivers of unethical sexual behaviour, violence against women, unwanted sexual attention, and misconduct on public transport in the megacities: Karachi and London?
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P: Population	Women in public spaces or who commute with public transport.
I: Intervention	Existing scholarly and grey literature
C: Comparison	Comparison between two megacities: Karachi and London
O: Outcome	What triggers unethical sexual behaviour in men? What are the driving agents?
C: Context	Megacities

PICOC Grid 2

REA Question no. 2	What is known in the existing scholarly and grey literature about the prevalence of public sexual harassment in the megacities: Karachi and London?
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P: Population	Women in public spaces or who commute with public transport.
I: Intervention	Existing scholarly and grey literature
C: Comparison	Comparison between two megacities: Karachi and London
O: Outcome	Prevalence Rate or Frequency of occurrence.
C: Context	Megacities

⁶ The term 'paraphilic attitude' is derived from paraphilia. In psychiatry, "paraphilia is defined as a mental disorder characterized by abnormal sexual desires, typically involving extreme or dangerous activities which may have social and legal consequences." Source: American Psychiatric Association, Diagnostic and Statistical Manual of Mental Disorders, Fifth Edition.

⁷ PICOC: It is a mnemonic of systematic review that stands for Population, Intervention, Comparison, Outcome, and Context.

PICOC Grid 3	
REA Question no. 3	What is known about factors that may provoke the occurrence of public sexual harassment in the megacities: Karachi and London?
P: Population	Women in public spaces or who commute with public transport.
I: Intervention	Existing scholarly and grey literature
C: Comparison	Comparison between two megacities: Karachi and London
O: Outcome	Identification of provocation
C: Context	Megacities
PICOC Grid 4	
REA Question no. 4	What strategies for reducing the public sexual harassment may be successful in Karachi and London and making these megacities a safer inhabitant on earth?
P: Population	Women in public spaces or who commute with public transport.
I: Intervention	Existing scholarly and grey literature
C: Comparison	Comparison between two megacities: Karachi and London
O: Outcome	Spot and discern the overall level of governmental concern to mitigate growing sexual harassment threats on public transport in the two megacities - London and Karachi.
C: Context	Megacities

4. Procedure

Following theoretical framework defines the scope (inclusion and exclusion criteria) of the research. The salient inclusion criteria cover:

- Sample size: Studies published between 1981 and 2018 with special focus on prevalence of sexual offences on public transport or in public spaces in megacities in general; studies/reports published with special focus on public sexual offences in the megacities – Karachi and London; studies focused on preventing/plummeting and counteracting threats of sexual offences on public transport and spaces;
- Language of publications: English
- Countries: All Countries
- Research Methods used: All research methods.

Rapid evidence assessment (REA) methodology was employed to: search the all- inclusive literature within stipulated time; collate descriptive outlines of the available evidences; critically analyse and evaluate it; sieve out studies of poor quality; and provide an overview of the evidence. The details are given in Fig. 1.

5. The magnitude of public sexual harassment in Karachi and London: a comparison of two megacities

The sexual harassment mayhem on public transport in the megacities of London, UK and Karachi, Pakistan has exacerbated with a large magnitude over the years. It has now become the most heightened issue being faced by the women living in these megacities. Many surveys on public sexual harassment have identified that women safety in public transport is the major issue in the two megacities. (Thomson Reuters Foundation, 2014; Clark, 2015; Mis, 2016). Hoor-Ul-Ain (2019) discussed the gravity of the issue highlighting the results of Thomson Reuters Foundation's, 2014 survey covering 16 world's largest capitals including several megacities. According to the survey, 3 megacities namely Tokyo, Beijing and London were rated eviler than New York. The survey was carried out in collaboration with a major UK polling company, YouGov. The survey findings were driven from the responses received from the experts and ambassadors of women's rights, gender equality, and gender-friendly urban spaces and as well as women living in those 16 cities. (Thomson Reuters Foundation, 2014).

The problem has now been recognized as a global issue for its ultimate resolve. Many conferences have been held, mainly in the United Kingdom, United States and Pakistan to explore its causes, consequences and resolution. The background research on the megacity

challenges focusing on the issues of how to make travelling in megacities women-friendly; finally led to addressing the megacities London and Karachi, the fastest growing cities in England and Pakistan with the population of more than 10 million and 24 million respectively (Turner, 2012; Cox, 2015; Peters, 2017).

According to the Thomson Reuters Foundation survey 2017, Karachi fared 2nd most perilous and unsafe megacity for women while London named the best. The survey asked international experts in women's issues in 19 megacities on how well women are protected from sexual violence, from harmful cultural practices, and if they have access to good healthcare, finance and education (Asian Correspondent, 2017; GEO, 2017; Reuters Staff, 2017). In megacities, provision of safe travel for women has become an issue of prime importance in the fields of public policy, law-making and urban planning and development (Asian Development Bank, 2015). Many researchers in the plenary session – 'How to make megacities women-friendly?' highlighted the problem of women safety and protection on public transport and in public spaces (Trust Conference, 2014).

5.1. Unbridled sexual harassment and women mobility issues in Karachi

Karachi, the megacity of lights is famous for its nightlife, economic activity, population, and geo-strategic location as the city that stays up for 24 hours a day and 7 days a week (Robotka, 2013; Agha, 2017). It is the capital of the Sindh Province of Pakistan and fastest growing megacity of the world with an estimated population of 24 million spread over 3530 sq. km (Qureshi, 2010; Demographia, 2014; Hasan, 2015).

In Karachi, public sexual harassment has become a daily torment for women and girls (DAWN, 2016; Khan, 2016). The evidences found in the scholarly and grey literature are authentic and significant. Many studies and media reports emphasized on the repeated occurrences of the public sexual harassment incidences with a higher frequency on streets, buses and in public spaces in the megacity of Karachi (Social Policy and Development Center (SPDC), 2014; Hasan, 2015; Hoor-Ul-Ain, 2016; Khan, 2016; Hoor-Ul-Ain, 2019).

The Daily Dawn reported a wide ranging of prevalence rates of unwanted sexual attention and behaviour encountered by women while travel on buses on television media – "When will Pakistani men stop harassing women on buses?" Women respondents very boldly shared analogous narratives emphasizing the women mobility issues and sexual offences incidences. The report shows that "Men in cars or on motorbikes stop next to them, offering them a lift, often persistently. When women refuse and continue waiting for their bus/ride, men start pestering them and harassing them" (DAWN, 2016; Nabi, 2016). The media file identified the incidences of sexual offences on streets and at bus stops as well. The situation demands the government to take immediate steps to address the daily ordeal and anguish of the survivors of the abuse.

In Karachi, women with high income groups predominantly prefer to commute safely with personally owned cars whereas women with low-income face the social ills of public sexual harassment as they rely on public buses, mini-buses, coaches and rickshaws for their daily commute (Anwar, 2013). With increasing demand of women travel, the city is beholding escalating rate of street crimes against women such as eve-teasing, ogling, cat-calling, poking and groping. The same has been supported by the survey analysis presented at the International Conference on Managing Megacities 2016; jointly organized by the University of Karachi, Karachi, Pakistan and George Mason University, VA, USA. According to the megacity survey 2016 on Karachi's transportation predicaments, 55% of the women respondents face sexual harassment on buses; the district East has been declared as the most unsafe area for women commuters as 83% women affirming the same response (Hoor-Ul-Ain, 2016; The Express Tribune, September 21, 2016; National Courier, September 22, 2016; Hoor-Ul-Ain, 2019). It is important to record that the Deputy Mayor Karachi of the time – Mr.

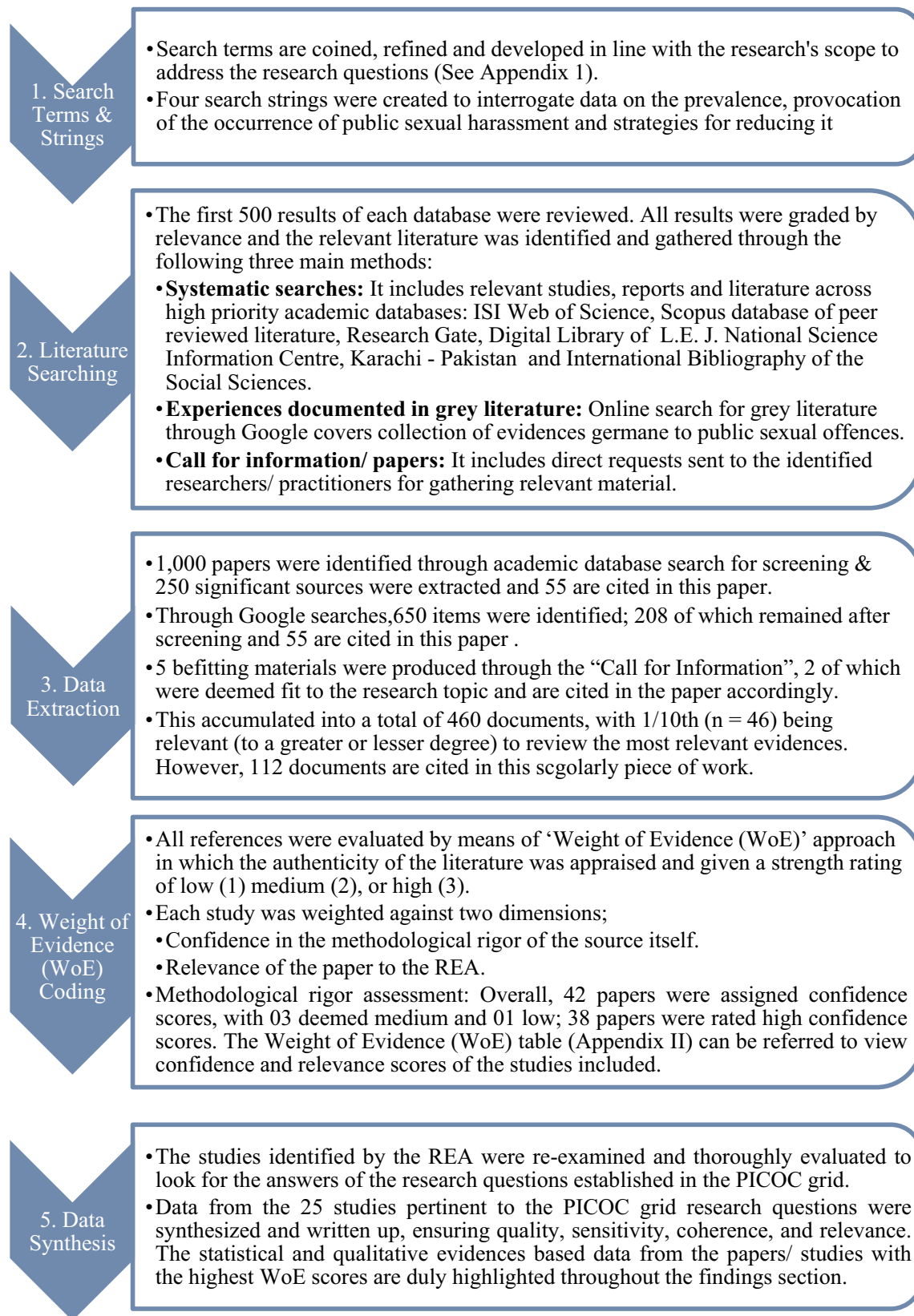


Fig. 1. Rapid evidence assessment (REA) process.

Arshad Vohra attended the conference and later seven newspapers wrote about the research findings to raise voice against the violence, sexual offences and harassment issues on buses ([The Daily Dawn, 2016](#); [PA News, 2016](#); [The Express Tribune, September 21, 2016](#); [National](#)

[Courier, September 22, 2016](#); [Business Recorder, 2016](#); [The News, September 22, 2016](#); [Express News \(Urdu\), 2016](#)). It has been two and a half years now, but no significant measures are taken by the government to stop this heinous crime on buses and streets.

Facing several mobility issues include waiting for longer hours at the bus stops, unsafe travelling patterns consists of risk of severe, moderately severe, and least severe sexual harassment; Karachi's women stand tall, leave for work and education from their homes (Sohail, Maunder, & Cavill, 2006; Hussain, 2009; Social Policy and Development Center (SPDC), 2014; Hasan, 2015; Nabi, 2016) to bridge the gender gap at the metropolis level (Kirk, 2004; Hussain, 2009; Syed, 2010; Ali, Krantz, Gul, Asad, & Johansson, 2011; Chaudhary, 2012).

Life of women commuters become more miserable during rush hour conditions as majority of men commuters travel by bus & droop on doors of women compartments which is already a small segmented space. The unavailability of apropos number of public buses let the men to invade the women vicinity which is already a very scanty and insufficient space for women to sit-in (Hasan, 2007). Women often encounter the issues of sexual offences from rikshaw, taxi, and qinjqi rikshaw drivers (Hasan, 2015).

An NGO – Humans of Pakistan worked in collaboration with UN Women for campaign on activism against gender-based violence to educate the masses to end violence against women by sharing 16 stories of different women with an endeavour to make Karachi a gender sensitized megacity. Among those 16 women, one reported that Hijabis⁸ face more incidents of sexual offences than those who don't wear headscarf and veil. Sharing her personal experience with the NGO, she brought this fact on record that she had not been spared in Burqa (Veil that covers a woman from head to toe). Highlighting her anguish; she told the NGO that she had been a victim of men gaze, poking, and unwanted sexual attention while being fully covered in Burqa (Human of Pakistan's and UN Women's Orange the World Campaign, 2016). Another documentary recorded by the Daily Dawn broadcast the galloping rate of nefarious activities of public sexual harassment with Hijabi women on buses, bus stops and streets on television media for the conviction of these wicked criminals (DAWN, 2016).

5.2. Unbridled sexual harassment and women mobility issues in London

London is the capital and most crowded megacity of England with an estimated population of 10 million spread over 1572 sq. km (UK Population, 2017). London is an oldest global city and famous for its active lifestyle, tourism, and transportation system. London is also known for Westminster Palace.⁹ Newspapers report that London's transport system is one of the safest and most efficient public transport networks in the world (Metro, 2007; Metro, 2015). But the system has been incapable of providing safe commute to the millions of girls and women living in London for several years. Sexual harassment on streets and public transportation is an everyday occurrence for them (Valentine, 1992; Walkowitz, 1998). Sadly, women are not safe in the city which is known for the adjudication of law. Lamentably, women are subject to unwanted sexual attention on their daily commute in the city which is the biggest royal residence in the United Kingdom. An international poll found that 32% of women in London have been verbally harassed on public transport and 19% were victims of direct physical abuse (MSN News, 2014; Thomson Reuters Foundation, 2014). The survey suggests that the large number of women have negative impacts on their mental health and emotional well-being. They experience feelings of fear, anger, and anxiety because of unwanted attention from men (Battered Women's Support Services, 2015b). Londoners face extremely troublesome incidents on public transport over the last two decades. In 2010, two women were wronged by an old man on the London Underground; he was sentenced for imprisonment for making lewd comments, groping their breasts and running away.

Another woman named Katie was harassed by a man while travelling by bus. A man pressed himself towards her when she was seated; she moved down the bus to get away from him, but he approached her again and pressed himself against her. She shouted for help, but nobody stood for her and she left the bus at the next stop helplessly. She did not report this offence. Quite a lot of such episodes of public sexual harassment remain unreported as many women are conditioned to develop self-coping mechanisms in London (Arnold, 2012).

Per Thomson Reuters Survey conducted in 2014, one in 10 Londoners experienced unwanted sexual behaviour on public transport but more than 90% did not report it to police (Thomson Reuters Foundation, 2014). The survey helped the British Transport Police in running a robust campaign to encourage women to report sexual offences at the police stations. Because of which women gained confidence in police to report sexual offence and abuse. The reported sexual offences on public transport had risen by 25% from 1117 to 1399 cases in 2014/15 - BTP¹⁰ (Clark, 2015). Another survey released on International Women's Day reports that two-thirds of British women in London faced sexual harassment in public places and more than one-third have experienced unwanted sexual touching (Mis, 2016). Serial sex attacks have been reported by six different women in London in January 2017 (British Transport Police, n.d.; Hartley, 2017).

The spiraling crime of sexual abuse, harassment, and assault in London has dwindled under the governance of Mr. Sadiq Khan, the Mayor of London who took up office on May 09, 2016. The mayor vowed to make London a safer city for women by publishing his four-year strategy of investing USD 61.03 million up to 2020 to deal with public sexual harassment against women in the British capital. The mayor urged Londoners to report sexist and misogynistic attitudes wherever spotted in public spaces. He funded the programmes: Stalking Threat Assessment Centre, Sexual Violence Services, and a project to rehabilitate perpetrators (Financial Express, 2018). Mayor of London's 100 pages' strategy document entitled "A safer city for women and girls (The London tackling Violence Against Women and Girls Strategy 2018-2021)" encapsulates his crystal clear vision to bridge the gender disparity by making London a safer megacity for women and girls with equal rights and opportunities; a counter narrative to violence against women and girls; a loud call to abhor and discourage misogyny; a bold approach to highlight the voices of survivors of sexual abuse to devise the right plan of action to tackle the misogynistic attitudes and behaviours in a tactful manner; robust and effective actions against the offenders and perpetrators; high priority protection and support for victims of public sexual harassment to safeguard their psychological, social, and emotional well-being; timely provision of criminal justice service (Mayor of London, 2018). The Mayor's strategy resulted into a charter which is an exemplary model for other megacities to follow as it covers the monitoring of the entire capital and sets out guidance for venues, operators, charities, councils and businesses to improve safety at night for women. This includes special training of staff, encouraging the reporting of all kinds of sexual offences/harassment, and ensuring public spaces and transport are safe for women. Fulfilling the demands of the Mayor's charter of improving women's safety at night in London, Deputy Mayor of London for Policing and Crime – Ms. Sophie Linden called the summit to bring together representatives from policing, transport, charities and the night-time economy to reaffirm their commitment to improving safety at night (Mayor of London - London Assembly, July 23, 2018).

Over 17,000 sexual offences were recorded by BTP in 2017 as a result of prompt and strict measures to stop public sexual offence on transport. Most of the cases are charged with offences and victims got justice with positive outcomes (BBC News, 2018; Mayor of London, 2018). The vicissitude of this worst offence has been curbed down through the monitoring of sex crimes on buses by London Transit and

⁸ Women covered in Burqa (Veil).

⁹ The Palace of Westminster is the meeting place of the House of Commons and the House of Lords, the two houses of the Parliament of the United Kingdom.

¹⁰ British Transport Police.

Sexual Assault Centre. The Center made the London buses equipped with video cameras and police may ask for the video records to investigate complaints of threats or assaults. Three complaints reported last year and two resulted in convictions. Consideration was only given to the incidents reported to police. However, most of the incidents remain unreported. To encourage women to report incidents of sexual offence, assault, and harassment, the London Transit Commission launched a campaign with an effort to make people more aware of the safety program in place since 1990s (Richmond, 2017).

6. Discussion

This comparative review of the two megacities: Karachi and London evinces the plight of public sexual harassment on transport with a high prevalence rate. Literature review as a reality check; accentuates the prevalence of sexual offences, harassment, and assaults in the two big cities with ever-progressive population, which warrant a safe and an intelligent public transport system, service, and network along with the social justice.

The literature reveals that the megacities are found to be the safe havens for the perpetrators involved in this crime and dangerous for women (PTI, 2013). The role of governments is critical in addressing sexual harassment on buses and sincere effort is required to overhaul the “inefficient policing system” in megacities with an aim to safeguard women from such undesirable incidents (UN Special Rapporteur on Violence against Women (SRVAW), 2003; Social Policy and Development Center (SPDC), 2014; Asian Development Bank, 2015; Thakran, 2015). The ‘Planet 50–50’ campaign of gender equality and rapid urbanizations bring with it an urgent need of provision for safe mobility and access (i.e., safe public transport) for women in megacities (UN Women, 2017).

In the light of evidences found in the scholarly and grey literature, Karachi falls under the category of severe type of street or public sexual harassment that includes physical violence against women, passing lewd or sexually explicit profane comments at women, physical acts such as following a woman, pinching, poking or groping her, or throwing things at her. Sexist gender norms, practices, and social structures contribute to violence against women in the region. They also make it harder for survivors to get the support, help, and justice they need to escape abuse and rebuild their lives. Moreover, the city government's services (health, legal, and social) are neither working together effectively nor in alignment with international best practices to provide the necessary support to the survivors of the abuse. However, the literature does not provide a definitive solution to the problem but identifies the reasons why public sexual harassment go unreported in Karachi. Research investigation suggests that majority of the women are unaware of their rights on sexual harassment. Lack of awareness of legal relief on sexual harassment prevention. Victims' fear of aggravating the situation and making matter worse such as fear to harm to one's social reputation leaves them helpless. Society's fear of being blamed as victim-survivor multiplies the number of victims globally. On top of that the criminal justice system and the law enforcement authorities do not encourage complaints as there is no law available in the city to protect women and girls against public sexual harassment yet; this puts the survivors of the abuse in an afflicted and bewildered state of mind (Awan, 2004; Hoor-Ul-Ain, 2019). Despite of several evidences highlighted in the news through television and print media on the quandary of public sexual harassment, no special heed was ever paid by the government for the legislation and enactment of the law to end violence against women on streets and public transport.

Corresponding to previous researches, this study also manifests the jeopardies of public sexual harassment women experience in Karachi while commuting from one place to another. Women cannot commute to their workplaces and back home in a respectful and safe manner. Similarly, girls experience the same while commuting with public transport to their education institutes and back home. Pakistan was

rated as the 3rd most unsafe country in the world for women in 2011, says Thomson Reuters Foundation's Trust Law Polls (Anderson, 2011) and now it's megacity – Karachi is fared as the second most dangerous city for women in the world as mentioned earlier in the literature findings (Reuters Staff, 2017).

Conversely, the existing literature illustrates a dramatic transition of the megacity of London from a category of ‘severe’ to ‘least severe’ type of public sexual harassment. Two decades ago, London was a city with a misogynistic mind-set where men assume it is their national duty to rape women who wear ripped, provocative, and sheer clothes (BBC News, 2012; Martinson, 2012; Express Tribune, 2017; Statistica, 2018). According to Thomson Reuters Survey 2014, London's public transport system ranked very unsafe for women. The paradigm shift came when Mr. Sadiq Khan, the city's Mayor assumed his office in 2016. He took excellent measures to devise and publish a five-year strategy plan to fight and end violence against women and girls (VAWG) (Mayor of London, 2018). For delivering this strategy, he called for a broad partnership of police communities, agencies, and local organisations to achieve the shared ambitions to prevent VAWG and arrest perpetrators and protect victims. First, he urged Londoner's to call out public sexual harassment if spotted anywhere and secondly, he made it possible by investing USD 61 million to establish a strong and effective network to monitor such cases though well-equipped and intelligent transportation system. Upon receiving any sexual harassment complaints on women passengers, the concerned department of the VAWG protection network becomes active, disseminate information, and extend support services to the survivor of the abuse. Mayor Sadiq Khan's efficacious strategy brought a goodly declining trend in the number of cases filed on the complaints of public sexual harassment. Now, London has been regarded as a safest megacity for women because the of the high-impact governmental concern to mitigate growing sexual harassment and assaults threats on women in public spaces and on transport. London believes in the supremacy of the law and British Law provides absolute protection to the women on roads and buses; they only need to report public sexual harassment cases to the British Transport police to stop it (British Transport Police, n.d.). Conviction of the perpetrators are guaranteed by the law.

7. Conclusion and recommendations

The issue of public sexual harassment is one of the persistent and emerging challenges in both the megacities: Karachi and London. It causes mental fatigue and trauma to the women commuters and defile their mental health and wellbeing. London's case may be used as a model for improving the safety conditions for women commuters in Karachi. To lessen the risk of sexual offence, harassment, and assault on transport in Karachi, the provincial and city governments must call the law enforcement agencies to deal with the prevalent jeopardy and take strict action against such perpetrators. Comparatively, the provincial and city governments of Karachi seem to be reluctant in taking the mayhem of public sexual harassment as top priority item on their agenda book and laying out a strategic framework for Karachi's women commuters as an ultimate resolve of the issue. The city with its growing number of women commuters looks for an increasing safety measures. Ironically, no policy or strategy have been introduced to stop the quandary of public sexual harassment for years (Hasan, 2015). The government and law enforcement agencies remained ineffective in providing any relief to women commuters despite having received thousands of complaints against the sexual offences because there is no law to safeguard or provide protection to women on roads and travelling on public transport (Hasan, 2015). Provision of safe public transportation system is observed as the critical most challenge and is a principal determinant of Karachi's reput at the international front as it is fared as the second most minacious megacity for women in the last Thomson Reuters survey (Reuters Staff, 2017).

Escalating trend in the daily public sexual harassment incidents on

public transport puts a pressure on the governmental machinery to address the Karachi's women mobility afflictions by taking following immediate steps:

- The enactment of ‘The Protection Against Harassment of Women at the Workplace Act¹¹’ in 2010 does not protect women from sexual harassment on the roads and buses. The act applies to the workplace only. Hence, legislating another law protecting women from sexual harassment on public transport has become a dire need of the time.
- In spirit of sustainability to end violence against women, a competent and well-equipped surveillance cell should be established to monitor the incidents of public sexual harassment on transport system.
- Karachi's Local Government should:
 - o call out immediate legislation to hold all transporters accountable legally by the concerned authorities by means of an accountability mechanism to report all incidences of sexual offences as a witness to provide safer transportation to women.
 - o run civic education campaigns on gender parity, diversity, inclusion and sensitization for men to educate them about respecting and safeguarding their opposite gender's rights and treating them as equal.
 - o introduce and run civic education campaigns to help women learn about their legal rights and obligations by means of civic engagement. In this connection, women of the region may feel empowered by:
 - seeking awareness of their rights
 - getting united to stand for each other in solidarity
 - speaking out against the incidences of sexual offences
- Self defense trainings should be made compulsory in all educational institutions and workplaces to spread awareness among the women commuters about their safety rights.
- The government should establish ‘Mental Health Rehabilitation Centers’ at the district level to provide peer therapy support comprised of an empathic group of women who meet to help each other navigate the incredibly painful and devastating aspects of sexual offences and assaults. Such support groups may be useful in

minimizing psychological damage in the event of post-abuse social exclusion by peers and family.

The research stipulates a dire need to draw the attention of the Karachi's city government to provide safer travel to the women and girls. The government should monitor the hideous crime of public sexual harassment in Karachi to catch the perpetrators red-handed on the spot. Absence of law to protect women on transport and in public spaces refrains the governmental administrative agencies to function effectively. Karachi's existing public transport is not able to cope with the increasing travel demand of women commuters and indicates an urgent need to adopt London's model of safer city and provide mass transit options at a subsidized rate.

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Appendix

Table 1

Search terms for “Public sexual harassment mayhem on public transport in megacities - Karachi and London: A comparative review”.

Behavioural terms	Transport terms or public spaces terms	Consequential terms	Prevention/cure terms
Sexual harassment	Public transport	Consequences of public sexual harassment	Impact
Public sexual harassment	Public buses	Rising rate of sex offences	Prevent
Street harassment	Public space	Psychological distress	Campaign
Sexual violence	Subway	Suicide attempt in women	Intervene
Sexual abuse	Underground	Mental health issues such as long-term depression, acute stress, anxiety, sleeplessness and even post-traumatic stress disorder (PTSD), etc.	Legal solution
Sexual assault	Transit	Physical health symptoms: manifestation of muscle aches, stress headaches, hyper tension & hypotension, diabetes and heart issues in chronic cases	Restoration of emotional well being
Sexual offence	Mass transit	Ill emotional health issues such as temperament, anger and self destruction.	Mediation
Sexual offence	Coach	Social vulnerability	Reconstruction of Self
Types of sexual harassment	Minibus	Financial and economic constraints such as layoffs, demotions, etc.,	Emotional support
Severe type of sexual harassment	Rapid transit	Low self esteem	Peer therapy
Moderate-severe sexual harassment	Tram	Low self worth	Social support
Less-severe sexual harassment	Shuttle	Poor self-concept	Social solidarity
Ogling	Bus stop	Lack of confidence	Parental support
Groping	Station	Substance abuse	Scheme

(continued on next page)

¹¹ Source: The Women Protection Against Harassment Act can be read at <https://www.qau.edu.pk/pdfs/ha.pdf>.

Table 1 (continued)

Behavioural terms	Transport terms or public spaces terms	Consequential terms	Prevention/cure terms
Cat-Calling	Train	Religious deterrence	Civic education
Misogyny	Street	Emotional distress	Gender sensitization
Lewd comments	Double-decker bus	Inferiority complex	Social development interventions
Sexist stereotypes	Cab	Rejection, embarrassment, social exclusion, bitterness, nervousness and anger	Surveillance
Public indecency	Taxi	Psychiatric morbidity	CCTV
Eve-teasing	Rikshaw	Mentally incapacitated	Monitoring
Wolf-whistling at women	Qinjq	Outcast	Patrolling
Pro-sexual behaviour	Tube	Societal vilification	Law making and legislation
Rape		Social exclusion	Implementation of law
Sexual attack			Police
Mayhem			British transport police
Sex objectification of women			Karachi traffic police
Paraphilia			Call-out!
Exhibitionism			
Frotteurism or touchrism			
Derogatory treatment			
Immorality and dishonor			
Unwanted sexual exposure			
Sexual behaviour			
Sexual behaviour			
Mental torture			
Emotional violence			
Emotional abuse			
Physical abuse			

Table 2

Sources, references, and weight of evidence scores.

Category of megacity	Source	References	Relevance Score	Confidence Score
Megacities in General	Academic	Gekoski, A., Gray, J. M., Adler, J. R., & Horvath, M. A. (2017). The prevalence and nature of sexual harassment and assault against women and girls on public transport: an international review. <i>Journal of Criminological Research, Policy and Practice</i> , 3(1), 3–16. doi: https://doi.org/10.1108/JCRPP-08-2016-0016	High	High
Megacities in General	Academic	Clark, S. K., Jeglic, E. L., Calkins, C., & Tatar, J. R. (2016). More than a nuisance: the prevalence and consequences of frotteurism and exhibitionism. <i>Sexual Abuse: A Journal of Research and Treatment</i> , 28(1), 3–19. Retrieved May 20, 2017, from http://journals.sagepub.com/doi/abs/10.1177/107906321452564	High	High
Megacities in General	Academic	Larry, S. J. (2016). Public Order Crime: Sex and Substance Abuse. In S. J. Larry, <i>Criminology: Theories, Patterns and Typologies</i> (13th ed., pp. 475–520). Boston, USA: Cengage Learning. Retrieved 11 01, 2017, from http://ebooks.narotama.ac.id/files/Criminology%20(11th%20Edition)/CHAPTER%2014%20Public%20Order%20Crime;%20Sex%20and%20Substance%20Abuse.pdf	Medium	High
Megacities in General	Academic	Lawlink. (1999). <i>Plan it safe: from wasteland to heartland</i> . Retrieved June 05, 2017, from www.lawlink.nsw.gov.au/swp/swp	Medium	High
Megacities in General	Google	Asian Correspondent. (2017, October 18). <i>What are the most dangerous megacities for women in Asia?</i> Retrieved from Asian Correspondent: https://asiancorrespondent.com/2017/10/dangerous-megacities-women-asia/#Brbzxreiduiel8jD.97	High	High
Megacities in General	Google	Reuters Staff. (2017, October 16). <i>EXCLUSIVE -Cairo named most dangerous megacity for women; London best - poll</i> . Retrieved from REUTERS: https://af.reuters.com/article/africaTech/idAFL8N1L74J3	High	High
Megacities in General	Google	Peters, S. (2017, January 3). <i>The World's 31 Mega-Cities</i> . Retrieved April 14, 2017, from http://247wallst.com/special-report/2017/01/03/the-worlds-31-mega-cities/2/	Low	Medium
Megacities in General	Google	Cox, W. (2015, April 19). <i>The World's Ten Largest Megacities - The Huffington Post</i> . Retrieved April 14, 2017, from http://www.huffingtonpost.com/wendell-cox/the-worlds-ten-largest-me_b_6684694.html	Medium	Low
Megacities in General	Google	Thomson Reuters Foundation. (2014, November 06). Thomson Reuters Foundation Poll. <i>Ranking the most dangerous transport systems for women in major cities</i> . Thomson Reuters Foundation News. Retrieved from http://thomsonreuters.com/en/articles/2014/most-dangerous-transport-systems-for-women.html	High	High
Megacities in General	Google	Trust Conference. (2014). <i>Plenary Session - How to make megacities women-friendly?</i> Retrieved April 08, 2017, from http://www.trustconference.com/videos/i/?id=e321d6cc-31be-4e2e-99c6-38a3e9920bb1&confYear=2014	High	High
Megacities in General	Google	UN Special Rapporteur on Violence against Women (SRVAW). (2003). <i>The United Nations Special Rapporteur on Violence against Women</i> . Retrieved May 09, 2017, from http://www.ohchr.org/Documents/Issues/Women/15YearReviewofVAWMandate.pdf	High	High
Karachi	Academic	Hoor-Ul-Ain, S. (2019). An empirical review of Karachi's transportation predicaments: A paradox of public policy ranging from personal attitudes to public opinion in the megacity. <i>Journal of Transport & Health</i> , 12(C), 164–182. doi: https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jth.2019.01.004	High	High
Karachi	Academic	Hasan, A. (2015). <i>Karachi: The Transport Crisis - A Report</i> . Karachi, Pakistan: Urban Resource Center.	Medium	High

(continued on next page)

Table 2 (continued)

Category of megacity	Source	References	Relevance Score	Confidence Score
Karachi	Academic	Social Policy and Development Center (SPDC). (2014). <i>Rapid Assessment of Sexual Harassment In Public Transport and Connected Spaces in Karachi</i> . Karachi: Asian Development Bank for ADB RETA 7563: Promoting Gender Inclusive Growth in Central and West Asia Developing. Retrieved from https://www.adb.org/sites/default/files/project-document/152881/44067-012-tacr-19.pdf	High	High
Karachi	Academic	Hussain, I. (2009). <i>Problems of working women in Karachi, Pakistan</i> . Newcastle upon Tyne: Cambridge Scholars Publishing.	Medium	High
Karachi	Academic	Sohail, M., Maunder, D. A., & Cavill, S. (2006). Effective regulation for sustainable public transport in developing countries. <i>Transport Policy</i> , 13(3), 177–190.	Low	Medium
Karachi	Call for Information	Khan, N. (2016, September 22). "Exclusive report on eve-teasing and harassment of women including cat-calling, ogling and teasing in public buses of Karachi." Retrieved from https://www.facebook.com/nazahat.khan/videos/vb.100002225817434/1146963962054453/?type=2&theater	High	High
Karachi	Call for Information	Hoor-Ul-Ain, S. (2016, September 22). Tehalka. (SAMAA TV, Interviewer) Retrieved from https://www.facebook.com/Syeda.Hoorulain.Naqvi/videos/vb.685696718/10154557939446719/?type=3	High	High
Karachi	Google	The Daily Dawn. (2016). <i>Vohra seeks Karachi's financial share</i> . Retrieved September 20, 2018, from https://epaper.dawn.com/DetailNews.php?StoryText=22_09_2016_118_006	Low	High
Karachi	Google	Business Recorder. (2016). 'Karachi needs more funds to overcome major municipal challenges. Retrieved September 20, 2018, from http://epaper.brecorder.com/2016/09/23/9-page/796368-news.html	Medium	High
Karachi	Google	National Courier. (September 22, 2016). <i>55pc Female Commuters Sexually Harassed: Research</i> . Retrieved from https://nationalcourier.pk/metropolis/55pc-female-commuters-sexually-harassed-research/	High	High
Karachi	Google	DAWN. (2016, May 12). How often do Pakistani women get harassed on public transport? You would be surprised. Karachi, Sindh, Pakistan. Retrieved September 01, 2016, from https://youtu.be/YHKLVALV4HI	High	High
Karachi	Google	Nabi, I. (2016, May 12). When will Pakistani men stop harassing women on buses? Karachi, Sindh, Pakistan: The Daily Dawn. Retrieved from http://www.dawn.com/news/1244564	High	High
Karachi	Google	Human of Pakistan's and UN Women's Orange the World Campaign. (2016). <i>They did not even spare me in Burqa</i> . Retrieved August 23, 2018, from http://humansofpakistan.org/people-havent-even-spared-burqa/	High	Medium
Karachi	Google	The Express Tribune. (September 21, 2016). '55% women in Karachi face harassment'. Retrieved September 21, 2018, from https://tribune.com.pk/story/1185970/public-transportation-55-women-karachi-face-harassment/	High	High
Karachi	Google	Express News (Urdu). (2016). بسوی کی زیوں حالی سب سے بڑا مسئلہ بن گیا، سروے رپورٹ. Retrieved September 20, 2018, from https://www.express.com.pk/epaper/PoPupwindow.aspx?newsID=1103757080&Issue=NP_KHI&Date=20160922	High	High
Karachi	Google	Awan, Z. A. (2004). <i>Violence Against Women and Impediments in Access to Justice</i> . Karachi, Pakistan: World Bank. Retrieved May 31, 2017, from http://www.wluml.org/node/7333	Medium	High
London	Academic	Vera-Gray, F. (2016). <i>Men's Intrusion, Women's Embodiment (A critical analysis of street harassment)</i> (1st ed.). London: Routledge: Taylor & Francis Group. doi: https://doi.org/10.4324/9781315668109	Medium	High
London	Academic	Walkowitz, J. R. (1998). Going Public: Shopping, Street Harassment, and Streetwalking in Late Victorian London. <i>Representations</i> , 62(Spring), 1–30. doi: https://doi.org/10.2307/2902937	High	High
London	Academic	Valentine, G. (1992). LONDON'S STREETS OF FEAR. In A. Thornley (Ed.), <i>The Crisis of London</i> (1st ed., p. 10 pages). London: Routledge. doi: https://doi.org/10.4324/9780203415238	High	High
London	Academic	Kissling, E. A. (1991). Street harassment: The language of sexual terrorism. <i>Discourse & Society</i> , 2(4), 451–460.	Medium	High
London	Google	Mayor of London. (2018). <i>A safer city for women and girls (The London tackling Violence Against Women and Girls Strategy 2018–2021)</i> . London: Greater London Authority. Retrieved July 01, 2018, from https://www.london.gov.uk/sites/default/files/vawg_strategy_2018-21.pdf	High	High
London	Google	Mayor of London - London Assembly. (July 23, 2018). <i>Pledge to improve women's safety at night in London</i> . Retrieved August 01, 2018, from https://www.london.gov.uk/press-releases/mayoral/pledge-to-improve-womens-safety-at-night	High	High
London	Google	Financial Express. (2018, March 10). <i>London mayor Sadiq Khan vows to make city safer for women</i> . Retrieved June 02, 2018, from Financial Express: https://www.financialexpress.com/world-news/london-mayor-sadiq-khan-vows-to-make-city-safer-for-women/1093584/	High	High
London	Google	BBC News. (2018, October 5). <i>More sexual offences reported on British railways</i> . Retrieved February 10, 2019, from BBC News: https://www.bbc.com/news/uk-45752322	High	High
London	Google	Financial Express. (2018, March 10). <i>London mayor Sadiq Khan vows to make city safer for women</i> . Retrieved June 02, 2018, from Financial Express: https://www.financialexpress.com/world-news/london-mayor-sadiq-khan-vows-to-make-city-safer-for-women/1093584/	High	High
London	Google	Hartley, R. (2017, January 29). Serial sex attacker on London buses who has targeted at least six women. <i>Parkinson for Metro.co.uk</i> . London. Retrieved February 20, 2017, from http://metro.co.uk/2017/01/29/serial-sex-attacker-on-london-buses-who-has-targeted-at-least-six-women-6412539/	High	High
London	Google	Mis, M. (2016, March 08). <i>Two-thirds of British women sexually harassed in public places - survey</i> . Retrieved January 15, 2017, from Thomson Reuters Foundation: http://news.trust.org/item/20160308143951-11dnj	High	High
London	Google	Laville, S. (2016, July 15). <i>Is wolf-whistling at women set to become a hate crime?</i> Retrieved from The Guardian: https://www.theguardian.com/lifeandstyle/2016/jul/15/is-wolf-whistling-a-woman-set-to-become-a-hate-crime	High	High
London	Google	Battered Women's Support Services. (2015, November 10). <i>TransitTuesday, Sexual Harassment on Public Transportation is a Problem We Must Solve</i> . Retrieved June 03, 2017, from http://www.bwss.org/sexual-harassment-on-public-transportation-is-a-problem-we-must-solve/	High	High
London	Google	Clark, T. (2015, August 26). <i>Rise in reported UK transport sex offences, women-only areas mooted</i> . Retrieved February 05, 2017, from Reuters: http://www.reuters.com/article/britain-women-transport-idUSL5N1112HJ20150826	High	High
London	Google	MSN News. (2014). <i>Most dangerous transport systems for women</i> . Retrieved June 02, 2017, from https://www.msn.com/en-sg/news/other/most-dangerous-transport-systems-for-women/ss-AA9sp6G#image=5	High	High
London	Google	Arnold, J. (2012). <i>Sexual harassment on public transport must stop - The Guardian</i> . Retrieved July 13, 2017, from https://www.theguardian.com/commentisfree/2012/jul/03/sexual-harassment-women-public-transport	High	High
London	Google	BBC News. (2012). <i>Many women 'feel unsafe on London transport' - YouGov</i> . Retrieved from https://www.bbc.com/news/uk-england-london-17557266	High	High
London	Google	Martinson, J. (2012). <i>London: the worst place in the UK to be a woman - The Guardian</i> . Retrieved from https://www.theguardian.com/lifeandstyle/the-womens-blog-with-jane-martinson/2012/apr/19/london-worst-place-women	High	High
London	Google	British Transport Police. (n.d.). <i>Rape and sexual assault</i> . Retrieved June 03, 2017, from British Transport Police: http://www.btp.police.uk/safety_on_the_railway/keeping_yourself_safe/rape_and_sexual_assault.aspx	High	High

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